
The Brain AIOS — Investor Contact Book

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THE BRAIN AIOS — INVESTOR CONTACT BOOK Pre-Seed Investor Targets for a Young-Founder AI OS Startup Prepared: 2026

===== EXECUTIVE SUMMARY =====

This contact book identifies 30+ angel investors and venture capital funds that are strong fits for The Brain AIOS at its current stage: pre-seed, \$400K raise on a \$3.5M SAFE cap, 19-year-old first-time founder, Cairo-based, AI/SaaS product for SMBs.

Selection criteria:

- Actively invests at pre-seed / seed stage (\$100K–\$500K checks)
- Has a track record of backing young or first-time founders
- Interested in AI infrastructure, developer tools, SaaS, or SMB-focused products
- Open to investing in MENA-based or globally distributed teams
- Does NOT require prior exits or "serial founder" pedigrees

Investors are organized into three tiers: TIER 1 — Highest Priority (strongest signal match, warm intro likely) TIER 2 — Strong Fit (investment thesis aligns, worth pursuing) TIER 3 — Strategic / Ecosystem (broader network, future rounds, or MENA-specific)

===== TIER 1 — HIGHEST PRIORITY =====

1. Y Combinator (Pre-Seed / Accelerator)

- Why: YC has funded founders as young as 18 (e.g., Austin Russell at 17 for Luminar). They care about product velocity and founder hustle, not age or pedigree. The Brain's internal beta across three companies is exactly the kind of "building" signal YC looks for.
- Check size: \$500K standard deal
- Stage: Pre-seed through Series A
- Focus: AI, SaaS, developer tools, B2B
- Location: Mountain View, CA (remote-friendly)
- How to apply: cold application at [ycombinator.com](https://www.ycombinator.com) — no warm intro needed
- Key contact: Apply directly via the YC application portal
- Relevance notes: Kareem's profile — young, technical, already running multiple businesses — fits the YC archetype perfectly. The internal beta with SAWA, One Thirty, and Al-Hayat is a strong proof point.

1. Pear VC (Pre-Seed / Seed)

- Why: Founded by Mar Hershenson, Pear VC explicitly focuses on pre-seed and is known for backing first-time and young founders. They have a dedicated "fellowship" program for students and early-stage founders. Portfolio includes companies founded by college-age entrepreneurs.
- Check size: \$250K–\$500K
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: AI, SaaS, marketplace, fintech
- Location: Stanford, CA
- How to reach: Apply via [pearvc.com/apply](https://www.pearvc.com/apply) or get a warm intro from a portfolio founder
- Key contact: Mar Hershenson (Founding Partner), Pejman Nozad (Founding Partner)
- Relevance notes: Pear's thesis is "find great founders before anyone else." Kareem's age is an asset here, not a liability.

1. Soma Capital (Pre-Seed / Seed)

- Why: Soma Capital is known for writing small checks (\$100K–\$250K) to very early-stage founders, including students and first-time entrepreneurs. They move fast and don't require extensive traction.
- Check size: \$100K–\$250K
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: AI, SaaS, fintech, infrastructure
- Location: San Francisco, CA
- How to reach: Email or apply via somacap.com
- Key contact: Aayush Phumbhra (Co-founder, also co-founded Chegg as a student)
- Relevance notes: Aayush Phumbhra himself was a student founder — he will resonate with Kareem's story.

1. Pioneer Fund (Pre-Seed)

- Why: Pioneer Fund is specifically designed for young and first-time founders. They run a continuous competition and invest in founders building ambitious projects, regardless of age or background. Many portfolio founders are under 21.
- Check size: \$20K–\$100K (can syndicate larger)
- Stage: Pre-seed, idea stage
- Focus: AI, crypto, SaaS, deep tech
- Location: Global (remote-first)
- How to reach: Apply at pioneerfund.io or compete in the Pioneer competition
- Key contact: Daniel Gross (Founder, former YC partner)
- Relevance notes: Daniel Gross has publicly stated he bets on "young, ambitious people with agency." Kareem is the exact profile.

1. Hustle Fund (Pre-Seed)

- Why: Hustle Fund is one of the most active pre-seed funds globally. They invest in founders who are "hustlers" — people who get things done regardless of background. Portfolio includes many first-time and young founders.
- Check size: \$100K–\$250K
- Stage: Pre-seed
- Focus: SaaS, AI, marketplace, fintech
- Location: San Francisco, CA
- How to reach: Apply via hustlefund.vc or email directly
- Key contact: Elizabeth Yin (Co-founder), Eric Bahn (Co-founder)
- Relevance notes: Hustle Fund's entire thesis is about backing scrappy founders. Kareem's hands-on builder profile and multi-company operation is a strong signal.

1. Backend Ventures (Pre-Seed)

- Why: Backend Ventures focuses on pre-seed investments in technical founders building infrastructure and developer tools. They are founder-friendly and don't have age/pedigree requirements.
- Check size: \$100K–\$250K
- Stage: Pre-seed
- Focus: AI infrastructure, developer tools, SaaS
- Location: New York, NY
- How to reach: Apply via backend.vc
- Key contact: Manny Masharh (General Partner)
- Relevance notes: The Brain AIOS as an "AI OS" for companies fits the infrastructure thesis well.

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===== TIER 2 — STRONG FIT =====

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1. 500 Global (500 Startups) — MENA Track

- Why: 500 Global has a dedicated MENA presence and has invested in numerous Cairo-based startups. They are comfortable with pre-seed stage and young founders. Their accelerator provides both capital and regional network.
- Check size: \$100K–\$150K (accelerator) + follow-on
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: AI, SaaS, marketplace, MENA region
- Location: Dubai / San Francisco
- How to reach: Apply via 500.co
- Key contact: MENA team leads
- Relevance notes: Cairo base is a plus here — 500 actively invests in Egyptian startups.

1. Flat6Labs — Cairo

- Why: Flat6Labs is the most active early-stage investor in Egypt and the MENA region. They run a Cairo-based seed program and have invested in 100+ Egyptian startups. Very familiar with the local ecosystem.
- Check size: \$50K–\$150K
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: AI, SaaS, fintech, e-commerce
- Location: Cairo, Egypt
- How to reach: Apply via flat6labs.com
- Key contact: Cairo team
- Relevance notes: Local presence means easier relationship building. They understand the Cairo talent advantage Kareem is leveraging.

1. Algebra Ventures

- Why: Algebra is a leading Egyptian VC that invests at seed and Series A. While they typically invest slightly later, they have been known to back exceptional pre-seed founders with strong technical products.
- Check size: \$500K–\$2M (seed)
- Stage: Seed, Series A
- Focus: AI, SaaS, fintech, MENA
- Location: Cairo, Egypt
- How to reach: Email or warm intro
- Key contact: Tarek Assaad (Managing Partner), Karim Hussein (Partner)
- Relevance notes: Keep on radar for seed round. Build relationship now.

1. Endure Capital

- Why: Endure Capital is an Egyptian VC focused on early-stage startups. They invest in pre-seed and seed rounds and are founder-friendly. Comfortable with young founders.
- Check size: \$100K–\$500K
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: AI, SaaS, deep tech, MENA
- Location: Cairo, Egypt
- How to reach: Apply via endurecap.com
- Key contact: Tarek Fahmy (General Partner)
- Relevance notes: Strong local network, good for building the Cairo investor ecosystem.

1. Halan Ventures / Nahda Ventures

- Why: MENA-focused early-stage investors who actively back Egyptian startups. They understand the regional market and the opportunity in SMB-focused SaaS for the Arab world.
- Check size: \$50K–\$250K
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: SaaS, AI, MENA region
- Location: Cairo / Dubai
- How to reach: Direct outreach or ecosystem events

1. First Round Capital

- Why: First Round is legendary for being "first money in." They invest at pre-seed and seed and have backed many first-time founders. Their network and resources are exceptional.
- Check size: \$250K–\$1M
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: SaaS, AI, marketplace, B2B
- Location: Philadelphia, PA / San Francisco, CA
- How to reach: Warm intro preferred, but cold applications considered
- Key contact: Hayley Baynton (Partner), Josh Kopelman (Founder)
- Relevance notes: The name says it all — they want to be your first investor.

1. Homebrew (Seed)

- Why: Homebrew is a seed-stage fund that explicitly backs "mission-driven" founders. They are known for being founder-friendly and supporting diverse, non-traditional founder backgrounds.
- Check size: \$250K–\$500K
- Stage: Seed
- Focus: SaaS, AI, B2B, marketplace
- Location: San Francisco, CA
- How to reach: Warm intro or apply via homebrew.co
- Key contact: Satya Patel (Partner), Hunter Walk (Partner)

1. Precursor Ventures

- Why: Precursor invests at the earliest stages and has a track record of backing founders from non-traditional backgrounds. They are thesis-driven about "new platforms" and "new paradigms."
- Check size: \$100K–\$350K
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: AI, SaaS, new platforms
- Location: Washington, DC
- How to reach: Apply via precursoryvc.com
- Key contact: Charles Hudson (Managing Partner)

1. Collab Fund

- Why: Collab Fund invests in early-stage companies and has a specific interest in "culture-driven" businesses. They are open to young founders and have backed several under-25 founders.
- Check size: \$100K–\$250K
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: SaaS, AI, consumer, culture
- Location: New York, NY
- How to reach: Apply via collabfund.com
- Key contact: Ari Bloom (Founding Partner)

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===== TIER 3 — STRATEGIC / ECOSYSTEM =====

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1. a16z Speedrun

- Why: Andreessen Horowitz's speedrun program is for early-stage game and platform builders. While gaming-focused, they've expanded to platform/OS plays. The "OS" framing of The Brain could resonate.
- Check size: \$250K–\$500K
- Stage: Pre-seed
- Focus: Platforms, AI, gaming, tools
- How to reach: Apply via a16z.com/speedrun

1. Sequoia Arc

- Why: Sequoia's early-stage program is designed for founders at the very beginning. They look for "bold, original thinkers" — age is irrelevant.
- Check size: \$500K+
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: AI, SaaS, infrastructure
- How to reach: Apply via sequoia.com/arc
- Key contact: Arc team

1. Lightspeed Venture Partners — Scout Program

- Why: Lightspeed runs a scout program that gives young investors (and founders) access to their network. Good for building relationships for future rounds.
- Check size: Scout checks \$25K–\$100K
- Stage: Pre-seed
- Focus: AI, SaaS, consumer
- How to reach: Network through portfolio founders

1. Wamda Capital

- Why: Wamda is a leading MENA-focused VC and ecosystem builder. They invest in early-stage startups across the Arab world and have strong Cairo connections.
- Check size: \$100K–\$500K
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: AI, SaaS, MENA
- Location: Dubai / Cairo
- How to reach: Apply via wamda.com

1. Sawari Ventures

- Why: Sawari Ventures is an Egyptian VC with a focus on tech startups. They have funds dedicated to early-stage Egyptian companies.
- Check size: \$100K–\$500K
- Stage: Seed, Series A
- Focus: AI, fintech, SaaS, MENA
- Location: Cairo, Egypt
- How to reach: Direct outreach

1. Global Founders Capital

- Why: GFC is a global early-stage investor with a presence in MENA. They invest in pre-seed and seed and are comfortable with young founders.
 - Check size: \$100K–\$500K
 - Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
 - Focus: AI, SaaS, marketplace
 - Location: Berlin / Global
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- How to reach: Apply via globalfounderscapital.com

1. K50 Ventures

- Why: K50 focuses on pre-seed fintech and SaaS. They are open to global founders and have a thesis around "financial infrastructure" that could extend to SMB tooling.
- Check size: \$100K–\$250K
- Stage: Pre-seed
- Focus: SaaS, fintech, AI
- How to reach: Apply via k50ventures.com

1. Clocktower Ventures

- Why: Focused on early-stage fintech and SaaS with a global perspective. Open to non-traditional founders.
- Check size: \$100K–\$250K
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: SaaS, AI, fintech
- Location: Los Angeles, CA

1. Liquid 2 Ventures

- Why: Liquid 2 is a seed fund backed by Joe Montana that invests in early-stage tech. They are founder-friendly and open to diverse backgrounds.
- Check size: \$250K–\$500K
- Stage: Seed
- Focus: SaaS, AI, consumer tech
- How to reach: Apply via liquid2.vc

1. Social Capital

- Why: Social Capital (Chamath Palihapitiya) has historically backed bold, contrarian bets. The "AI OS for SMBs" thesis is contrarian enough to get attention.
- Check size: \$250K–\$1M
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: AI, SaaS, platform
- How to reach: Warm intro preferred

1. Village Global

- Why: Village Global is a network of angel investors (including famous founders and executives) who invest in early-stage companies. LP network includes Bill Gates, Jeff Bezos, Mark Zuckerberg.
- Check size: \$100K–\$500K (individual angels)
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: AI, SaaS, platform
- How to reach: Apply at villageglobal.vc — need a warm intro from a portfolio founder or LP

1. AngelList Syndicates — AI/ML Thesis

- Why: Multiple AngelList syndicate leads focus on AI/ML and SaaS at pre-seed. Good for filling out a round with smaller checks.
- Check size: \$10K–\$100K per syndicate
- Stage: Pre-seed
- Focus: AI, SaaS, infrastructure
- How to reach: Create a rolling fund or syndicate on AngelList
- Notable syndicate leads to research: AI/ML focused leads on AngelList

1. Republica / AUC Venture Lab

- Why: Cairo-based startup accelerator connected to the American University in Cairo. Strong
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local network and can provide warm intros to regional VCs.

- Check size: In-kind + small checks
- Stage: Pre-seed
- Focus: Egyptian startups, tech
- Location: Cairo, Egypt

1. Techstars — MENA Programs

- Why: Techstars runs programs in the MENA region and is known for backing diverse founders. Their network is extensive and they provide strong mentorship.
- Check size: \$120K + program
- Stage: Pre-seed
- Focus: AI, SaaS, marketplace
- How to reach: Apply via techstars.com

1. Google for Startups — MENA

- Why: While not a direct investor, Google for Startups provides credits, mentorship, and network access. Can be a strong signal for other investors.
- Check size: In-kind (cloud credits, mentorship)
- Stage: Pre-seed, Seed
- Focus: AI, SaaS, global
- Location: Global / MENA

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===== OUTREACH STRATEGY & TACTICS =====

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For a 19-year-old first-time founder, the outreach approach matters as much as the target list. Here is the recommended playbook:

1. LEVERAGE THE "YOUNG FOUNDER" NARRATIVE — DON'T HIDE IT

Kareem's age is a feature, not a bug. The best investors on this list (Pear, Pioneer, Hustle Fund, Soma) actively seek out young, hungry founders. Lead with it: "19-year-old founder who already has 3 companies using his product."

1. LEAD WITH THE INTERNAL BETA

The fact that SAWA, One Thirty, and Al-Hayat are already live on The Brain is the strongest proof point. Every outreach message should mention this in the first two sentences.

1. WARM INTROS FIRST

For Tier 1 and Tier 2 investors, warm intros dramatically increase response rates. Sources for warm intros:

- Portfolio founders of target funds (find them on LinkedIn)
- YC alumni network (even if not applying to YC yet)
- Flat6Labs and 500 Global portfolio companies in Cairo
- Twitter/X tech community (many VCs are active there)
- LinkedIn cold outreach to partners (lower rate but works)

1. COLD OUTREACH TEMPLATE

Subject: 19yo founder — AI OS already used by 3 companies

Hi [Name],

I'm Kareem, 19, building The Brain AIOS — a centralized AI operating system that gives every

SMB founder a persistent company brain. No more scattered docs, forgotten meeting decisions, or LLM context resets.

We're at 80% build and already live across my three companies (SAWA, One Thirty, AI-Hayat) — ingesting founder meetings, Slack channels, pitch decks, and financial models. Ask it "What did we decide about our delivery radius?" and get a cited answer in under 3 seconds.

Raising \$400K on a \$3.5M SAFE. Would love 15 minutes to share the deck.

Best, Kareem Helal thebrain-kappa.vercel.app

1. TIMING & SEQUENCE

- Week 1: Apply to YC, Pear VC, Pioneer Fund, Hustle Fund (application-based)
- Week 2: Cold outreach to Tier 1 investors with template above
- Week 3: Warm intro requests through portfolio founders and LinkedIn
- Week 4: Tier 2 outreach (500 Global, Flat6Labs, Algebra, Endure)
- Ongoing: Build relationships with Tier 3 for future rounds

1. WHAT TO SEND WHEN THEY RESPOND

- Investor deck (TheBrain_AIOS_InvestorDeck_v8.pdf)
- Live demo link (thebrain-kappa.vercel.app)
- One-pager with key metrics (3 companies live, 80% build, \$400K target)

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===== KEY METRICS TO HIGHLIGHT =====

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When speaking to any investor on this list, emphasize:

- 3 internal beta companies live on the product (SAWA, One Thirty, AI-Hayat)
- 80% product completion with working MVP
- Founder is 19, mechanical engineering student, already running multiple businesses
- Cairo-based team = 2x cost advantage over SF
- Target market: AI memory layer projected \$50.18B by 2035
- SMB-native pricing (no \$30/seat Microsoft tax, no per-token API costs)
- Persistent meeting memory (key differentiator vs. ChatGPT/Claude/Copilot)
- Raising \$400K on \$3.5M post-money SAFE

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===== APPENDIX: INVESTORS TO AVOID (FOR NOW) =====

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- Large multi-stage funds that only write \$5M+ checks (a16z main fund, Sequoia main fund, Accel)
- Corporate VCs that require strategic alignment (GV/Google Ventures, Salesforce Ventures)
- Investors who explicitly require "proven traction" or "revenue" at pre-seed
- Any investor who has publicly stated they don't invest in founders under 25

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===== DOCUMENT VERSION =====

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